

An Analysis of Preaching Style

1.0 Introduction: Defining the Stylistic Framework

This document provides a thorough, descriptive analysis of a distinct preaching style, drawing from a corpus of seven sermons. The objective is not to offer a qualitative evaluation, but rather to methodically describe the "how" and "what" of the communication approach observed. By focusing on the tangible techniques and consistent patterns, this analysis seeks to illuminate the homiletic engine driving the messages.

The exploration is structured around the core pillars of the homiletic method. First, we will deconstruct the sermon architecture, examining the consistent structural pattern from the opening remarks to the concluding appeal. Next, the analysis will delve into the methods of biblical interpretation, highlighting a hermeneutic that weaves the Old and New Testaments into a single redemptive narrative. Following this, we will explore the specific rhetorical techniques—from colloquial language to contemporary analogies—that make complex theological concepts accessible.

Ultimately, this analysis aims to create a clear and comprehensive portrait of the homiletic approach demonstrated in the source material. By isolating and describing its core components, this document serves as a useful resource for reflection on the art and craft of pastoral communication.

2.0 Sermon Architecture: From Opening to Altar Call

The strategic importance of sermon structure in guiding a listener's journey—from initial engagement to a final call for response—cannot be overstated. Across the sermons analyzed, a remarkably consistent structural pattern emerges, forming a reliable framework for each message. This architecture functions as a rhetorical funnel, intentionally guiding the listener from a state of casual relatability to a moment of existential decision. This section will deconstruct that pattern.

2.1 The Conversational Opening: Establishing Rapport and Context

The typical sermon begins not with a formal scriptural reading, but with a multi-part, conversational introduction designed to build rapport and establish context.

This opening phase effectively disarms the audience before the formal message begins.

A key technique is the use of self-deprecating humor and casual asides, which rhetorically levels the authority gradient between the speaker and the congregation, thereby pre-disposing them to the message. This is achieved through personal anecdotes or cultural references:

"You can blame it on ADHD or whatever..."

"I'm a fan but I ain't blind if I was blind I'd be an SEC ref."

Following these informal remarks, the speaker provides clear context for the sermon, orienting the listener by explaining a shift in a teaching series or setting the historical stage for the biblical passage. The transition from these informal preliminaries to the sermon proper is consistently marked by a formal, invocational prayer. This prayer reveals a key theological belief about preaching itself: it is a work of divine recall and spiritual utterance, where the speaker intentionally recedes to become a conduit for the Holy Spirit.

"Would you pray for me this morning Lord i thank you for your word... I pray for your anointing God for you to bring to my remembrance the things that I've studied... God that you'll just let me compartmentalize this this word and and and preach it with faithfulness and boldness... Let me just be the mouthpiece And I ask God that you will speak and do a great and mighty thing..."

2.2 The Concluding Appeal: A Call for Response

Just as the sermons begin with a consistent pattern, they conclude with a direct and unambiguous call to action, consistently culminating in an altar call. This structure provides a definitive and actionable endpoint for the message, moving the listener from a posture of learning and exhortation to a moment of decision.

The appeal is often framed as an open invitation for individuals to respond to the spiritual needs addressed in the sermon. The language is direct, personal, and repeated for emphasis:

"This altar is open. Come come whatever you need..."

"If you're here this morning... This altar's open Come come and say Lord bring me back into your presence."

This architectural choice ensures that every sermon lands with a clear, practical step for the congregation. It transforms the message from a purely intellectual or emotional experience into an opportunity for tangible spiritual response.

3.0 Method of Biblical Interpretation: Weaving a Unified Redemptive Narrative

A preacher's hermeneutic—their method of interpreting scripture—is the intellectual and theological core of their style. It dictates not only what texts are used but how they are understood and connected. This section analyzes the consistent interpretive approach observed in the sermons: a method that weaves Old and New Testament passages together to form a single, Christ-centered redemptive story.

3.1 Text-Driven and Expository Foundation

The foundational approach is text-driven and expository. Each sermon is clearly anchored in a primary biblical passage (e.g., Genesis 17, Isaiah 53, Acts 16), which is read aloud to the congregation. This practice grounds the message in the authority of the biblical text and establishes a clear point of focus for the sermon's development.

3.2 Christ-Centered Typology and Cross-Textual Synthesis

The most prominent interpretive feature is a form of Redemptive-Historical or Christotelic interpretation that makes heavy and consistent use of typology. This method connects Old Testament events, figures, and symbols directly to the person and work of Jesus Christ, presenting them as foreshadows or "types" that find their ultimate fulfillment in the New Testament. This technique is the primary engine for synthesizing disparate parts of the Bible into a unified narrative pointing toward Jesus.

Key examples of this typological method include:

- **Isaac and Jesus:** A direct parallel is drawn between Isaac carrying the wood for his own sacrifice up Mount Moriah and Jesus carrying his cross to Golgotha. The father placing the wood on the son's shoulders is presented as a poignant foreshadowing of God the Father's sacrifice of his Son.

- **The Ram and the Crown of Thorns:** The ram caught by its horns in the thicket, which becomes Isaac's substitute, is explicitly linked to Jesus. The thorns of the thicket are identified as a symbol of the curse from Genesis 3, and the ram's entanglement is presented as a type of Jesus being crowned with those same thorns, becoming a curse-bearer for humanity.
- **Ishmael and the Forsaken Son:** The casting out of Ishmael into the desert—a moment of abandonment and near death—is portrayed as a narrative picture of Jesus being forsaken on the cross. Ishmael's thirst and isolation are used to illustrate Christ's spiritual separation from the Father.
- **Babel and Pentecost:** The confusion of languages at the Tower of Babel is argued to be spiritually reversed at Pentecost. Where human pride led to division and misunderstanding at Babel, the outpouring of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost resulted in the gift of a unified, heavenly language, restoring spiritual accord among God's people.

3.3 Lexical and Historical Contextualization

Depth is frequently added to the main text through explorations of original language and historical context. A key example is the lexical analysis of *EI Shaddai*, which the speaker deconstructs to reveal a dual meaning. By linking it to the Hebrew root *shad* ("breast"), the name is presented as signifying not only God's omnipotence but also His capacity for intimate nourishment and comfort.

Historical context is also used to frame biblical narratives and add moral complexity. For instance, the geopolitical struggle between Egypt, Assyria, and Babylon is detailed to explain the immense pressure on King Josiah. This contextualization serves to frame Josiah not just as a disobedient king, but as a leader making a high-stakes political calculation, adding depth to the sermon's point about his fateful decision.

While this Christ-centered hermeneutic forms the theological core of the message, its transmission to the congregation depends on a distinct and highly relational rhetorical style designed for maximum accessibility and impact.

4.0 Rhetorical Style: Fostering Connection and Clarity

Beyond a message's content, the rhetorical delivery is paramount to how it is received and processed by an audience. An effective rhetorical style can make

complex theology feel immediate, personal, and compelling. The style analyzed here utilizes a specific set of linguistic and rhetorical tools to make the biblical message accessible, engaging, and deeply relational.

4.1 Conversational and Accessible Tone

The predominant speaking style is highly conversational, informal, and relational. The use of colloquialisms, regional vernacular, and contractions creates a sense of familiarity and breaks down the formal barrier between the pulpit and the pews. This approach fosters an atmosphere of a shared conversation rather than a unilateral lecture.

Examples of this accessible tone include phrases like:

"Sin ain't always doing what's out right wrong..."

"y'all know what I'm talking about..."

4.2 Contemporary Analogies and Metaphors

A hallmark of this style is the frequent use of analogies and metaphors drawn from modern life and popular culture to illustrate biblical concepts. This technique bridges the gap between the ancient world of the text and the contemporary experience of the listener, making abstract theological ideas concrete and relatable.

Biblical Concept/Figure	Contemporary Analogy Used
Sarah's initial role in the covenant	A "non-playable character" from a video game.
God's sovereign authority (the signet ring)	A deactivated key card or a locked facility door.
The Church in Jerusalem vs. Antioch	A contentious business meeting with microphones for debate.
Jesus's role in the covenant	"He's the contract He is the constitution."
Human attempts to circumvent God's plan	Creating a "Plan B" because "God's plan A takes too long."

4.3 Narrative Storytelling

Biblical accounts are frequently retold as vivid, dramatic narratives. This technique performs a specific rhetorical function: it closes the "hermeneutical distance" by

translating an ancient character's presumed emotional state into a modern, relatable psychological experience. This makes figures like Sarah less of a historical artifact and more of a mirror for the congregation's own anxieties. For instance, when describing Sarah's perspective after the birth of Ishmael, her imagined internal monologue is voiced:

"am I going to be thrown off am I going to be cast aside... he's just going to leave me behind."

4.4 Engagement Through Direct Address and Questions

The audience is actively and consistently engaged through direct address and the use of rhetorical and introspective questions. This method pulls the listener into the sermon, prompting personal reflection and application of the message. It transforms passive listening into an active, internal dialogue.

Frequent questions are posed directly to the congregation, such as:

"you ever been there when you make a decision...?"

"Have you ever prayed and said 'God I need to hear from you.'?"

"What midnight are you in right now?"

Having examined *how* the message is delivered, we conclude by synthesizing the core elements that define this preaching style.

5.0 Conclusion: Synthesis of Stylistic Hallmarks

This analysis has examined the distinct preaching style demonstrated across a collection of seven sermons, focusing on its architecture, interpretive methods, and rhetorical techniques. The synthesis of these findings reveals a cohesive and intentional homiletic approach characterized by several key hallmarks.

The style can be summarized with the following descriptors:

- **Ritualized Architecture:** Sermons reliably follow a pattern that funnels the listener from a disarmingly conversational opening to an expository teaching section, culminating in a decisive appeal that calls for an immediate response.
- **Christ-Centered and Typological:** The primary hermeneutic interprets all of scripture as a single, unified story that points directly to the person and work

of Jesus Christ, with Old Testament figures and events serving as direct foreshadows of the gospel.

- **Rhetorically Vernacular and Analogical:** The delivery is marked by the use of informal language, contemporary analogies, narrative storytelling, and direct questions. These tools work in concert to dismantle formal barriers and build a strong, personal connection with the audience.
- **Application-Focused:** Every component, from the interpretive method to the final altar call, is geared toward translating ancient texts and theological principles into practical encouragement and direct challenge for modern life.

These combined elements create a distinctive preaching style that is deeply rooted in biblical narrative while remaining remarkably accessible and directly applicable to the congregation's lived experience. The result is a form of communication that is simultaneously theological, pastoral, and powerfully persuasive.